



Cloudy and quite cold 24/14 • Tomorrow: Windy and very cold 26/17 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, JANUARY 31, 2026 • \$4

In Kyiv, left out in the cold



DAN BASHAKOV/AP

Kyiv residents without power to their homes following Russia’s air attacks wait in line to receive free hot meals in the city’s downtown amid freezing temperatures on Friday. Russia said Friday that a moratorium on attacking Ukraine’s energy infrastructure, pushed by the United States, would expire on Sunday. **Story, A13**

ICE’s detention network plan rattles communities

BY JONATHAN O’CONNELL
AND DOUGLAS MACMILLAN

One industrial building the federal government plans to overhaul into an immigrant detention center, in Roxbury, New Jersey, draws groundwater from a small town that uses nearly all of its daily limit.

Another proposed detention site is a warehouse in Oklahoma City that would hold up to 1,500 people a little more than a mile from an elementary school and a Pentecostal church.

A third location, previously an auto parts distribution center in Chester, New York, became so unbearably hot during summer

Bid to buy warehouses across U.S. draws safety, humanitarian concerns

months that two people who used to work there said it was akin to being stuck inside an aluminum shed.

Those are a few of the logistical and humanitarian concerns raised by residents and local officials in some of the 23 towns where U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement plans to convert industrial buildings into detention centers that, com-

bined, would hold up to 80,000 people. ICE has offered few details about its plan since The Washington Post first reported on it last month.

As specific sites have surfaced in news reports, people in those communities have taken steps to block the projects.

“I’m not sure that this is the type of detention that is humane,” Quinton Lucas, the mayor of Kansas City, Missouri, said in an interview about plans to transform a warehouse there into an ICE facility that could hold up to 7,500 people. On Jan. 15, the same day that local news photographers documented ICE officials inspecting the building,

the city council passed a five-year ban on all new nonmunicipal detention facilities.

ICE expects to hold between 1,500 and 10,000 detainees in each of these 23 warehouses at a time, according to documents and interviews. But some experts have warned that it will be difficult to bring the industrial buildings up to federal standards for detention facilities in the short time before ICE plans to begin housing people in them.

The expansion of ICE’s detention system would help fulfill President Donald Trump’s goal of deporting millions of people by creating a hub-and-spoke model

SEE DETENTION ON A4

Justice Dept. opens civil rights probe of Pretti shooting

REVERSAL FOLLOWS WIDESPREAD CRITICISM

Investigation initially was limited to review by DHS

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK
AND PERRY STEIN

The Justice Department said Friday it has opened a civil rights investigation into the shooting of Alex Pretti by federal agents in Minneapolis last weekend, a reversal from its handling so far of shootings involving agents during the Trump administration’s immigration crackdown in Minnesota.

“We’re looking at everything that would shed light on that day,” Deputy Attorney General Todd Blanche said at a news conference Friday. Blanche said FBI investigators will continue to work with the Department of Homeland Security, which has been conducting its own “use of

force” investigation into whether its agents followed protocol during the incident.

But even as he disclosed the existence of the new inquiry, Blanche sought to downplay its significance, saying he did not want to “overstate what’s happening.”

“This is what I would describe as a standard investigation by the FBI when there are circumstances like what we saw last Saturday,” he said. “And that investigation — to the extent it

SEE INVESTIGATION ON A4

Don Lemon arrested: Charged in connection with church protest. **A3**

ICE marches: Thousands across U.S. decry enforcement tactics. **A5**

DOJ releases another cache of Epstein papers

Disclosure of 3 million more pages comes a month after deadline

BY PERRY STEIN
AND AMY B WANG

The Justice Department released what it said were 3 million more pages on Friday from the investigation of convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, the latest drop in the agency’s troubled scramble to comply with a federal law that requires the public release of files from the high-profile case.

Deputy Attorney General Todd Blanche said at a news conference Friday that this tranche of files —

which include 2,000 videos and 180,000 images — is expected to be the last major release of Epstein materials.

The release, more than a month after the Dec. 19 deadline set by law, was the result of work by hundreds of lawyers across the Justice Department who have spent weeks reviewing the files and redacting any information that might identify victims, Blanche said. The effort required significant time and personnel resources from the Justice Department, pulling top prosecutors from D.C., Florida and New York to review the files.

The documents are expected to provide an extensive look at the evidence the department gathered in its effort to prosecute Epstein, a politically connected

SEE EPSTEIN ON A18

Bomb cyclone is set to drive bitter winds and brutal chill into D.C.

BY JASON SAMENOW
AND IAN LIVINGSTON

The most frigid weather of the winter is coming to the D.C. area this weekend, as another surge of Arctic air blasts into the region. The cold will intensify as a powerhouse coastal storm — a nor’easter — rapidly strengthens off the Mid-Atlantic coast.

The storm will meet the meteorological definition of a bomb cyclone, intensifying explosively as it tracks well offshore. It will develop too far away to produce substantial snow in the D.C. area, but it will draw punishing winds southward late Saturday through Sunday, with gusts up to 40 mph.

Wind chills are poised to dip below zero Saturday night and hover in the single digits much of Sunday.

This weekend’s cold will mark the harshest stretch of a long-running cold spell that began Saturday and will only gradually ease next week.

The unforgiving temperatures

SEE WEATHER ON A8

Nor’easter: 12 cities in the path from Southeast to New England. **A8**

CATHERINE O’HARA | 1954-2026

Comedy star with a flair for the absurd and sweet

From beginnings in improv to roles in ‘Home Alone,’ ‘Schitt’s Creek’ and more

BY HARRISON SMITH,
SAMANTHA CHERY
AND ELAHE IZADI

Catherine O’Hara, the Canadian-born actress and comedian who could be deliciously silly or endearingly offbeat, appearing in movies such as “Beetlejuice” and “Home Alone” before reaching a new generation of fans as the narcissistic matriarch on “Schitt’s Creek,” died Jan. 30 at her home in Los Angeles. She was 71.

Creative Artists Agency, which represented her, said in a statement that she died “following a brief illness” but did not provide additional details.

Ms. O’Hara was known as a brilliant improviser, adept at channeling the humanity of characters she played for laughs without belittling them in the process.

“Catherine O’Hara was one of the rare performers who could disappear completely into a character and somehow

make that character unforgettable,” Journey Gunderson, the executive director of the National Comedy Center, said in a statement. “She shaped what comedy acting could be — blending precision, humanity and originality in a way that felt effortless but was anything but.”

Long before she won an Emmy Award for playing a self-absorbed former soap opera star on “Schitt’s Creek,” Ms. O’Hara appeared with Eugene Levy, one of the show’s creators and stars, on “Second City Television,” a Canadian sketch series that established her as a master of absurdist comedy and outsize characters.

By then, she said, she had developed an essential performance trick: “When in doubt, play insane. Because you didn’t have to excuse anything that came out of your mouth. It didn’t have to make sense.”

Ms. O’Hara shared five Emmy nominations as a writer

SEE O’HARA ON A6



ROBBY KLEIN/GETTY IMAGES FOR IMDB

Catherine O’Hara was recently nominated for two Emmy Awards, for her work in “The Studio” and “The Last of Us.”

Trump selects Kevin Warsh as next chair of Federal Reserve

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN
AND JACOB BOGAGE

President Donald Trump said he would nominate Kevin Warsh as the next chair of the Federal Reserve, putting a former Fed governor and Wall Street veteran at the helm of an institution the president has repeatedly attacked for not cutting interest rates more aggressively to spur growth.

“I have known Kevin for a long period of time and have no doubt that he will go down as one of the GREAT Fed chairmen, maybe the best,” Trump said on his social media platform early Friday. “On top of everything else, he is ‘central casting,’ and he will never let you down.”

Warsh, 55, was passed over in 2017, when Trump instead elevated Jerome H. Powell. Previously a Fed governor from 2006 to 2011, Warsh was the youngest in the institution’s history at 35 and served as a key Wall Street liaison during the financial crisis. He also served as an economic

SEE WARSH ON A7

The economy: Once “hawkish” on rates, Warsh now calls for cuts. **A7**

IN THE NEWS

Weekend shutdown The Senate passed an agreement Friday to fund the government, but a short funding lapse is still likely as the House is out until Monday. **A3**

CEO’s killing Luigi Mangione will not face the death penalty over charges of stalking and killing Brian Thompson, a judge ruled. **A18**

THE NATION
A new order signed by the president imposes tariffs on countries that supply oil to Cuba. **A14**
President Trump threatened penalties and to decertify planes made in Canada. **A14**

THE WORLD
Iraqi leaders nominated Nouri al-Maliki as prime minister despite a U.S. warning. **A12**
Balloons from Belarus carrying contraband cigarettes pose a test for NATO’s defenses. **A12**

THE ECONOMY
As the tech industry pours billions into AI, it’s slashing jobs by the thousands, turning a surefire career into another shaky job. **A15**
Donald Trump and his two eldest sons sued the IRS and Treasury Department over tax data leaked in first term. **A18**

STYLE
Grammy-nominated songwriter Laura Veltz knows country, plus a whole lot more, writing the sweetest songs — and the dirtiest viral hit of 2025. **B1**
At the premiere for “Melania” at the Kennedy Center, it was a grand old party. **B1**

SPORTS
The Australian Open has a men’s final of two champions chasing history: Novak Djokovic vs. Carlos Alcaraz. **B7**
METRO
Jury deliberations were underway Friday over whether Brendan Banfield orchestrated a lurid double murder. **B13**

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The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54478

